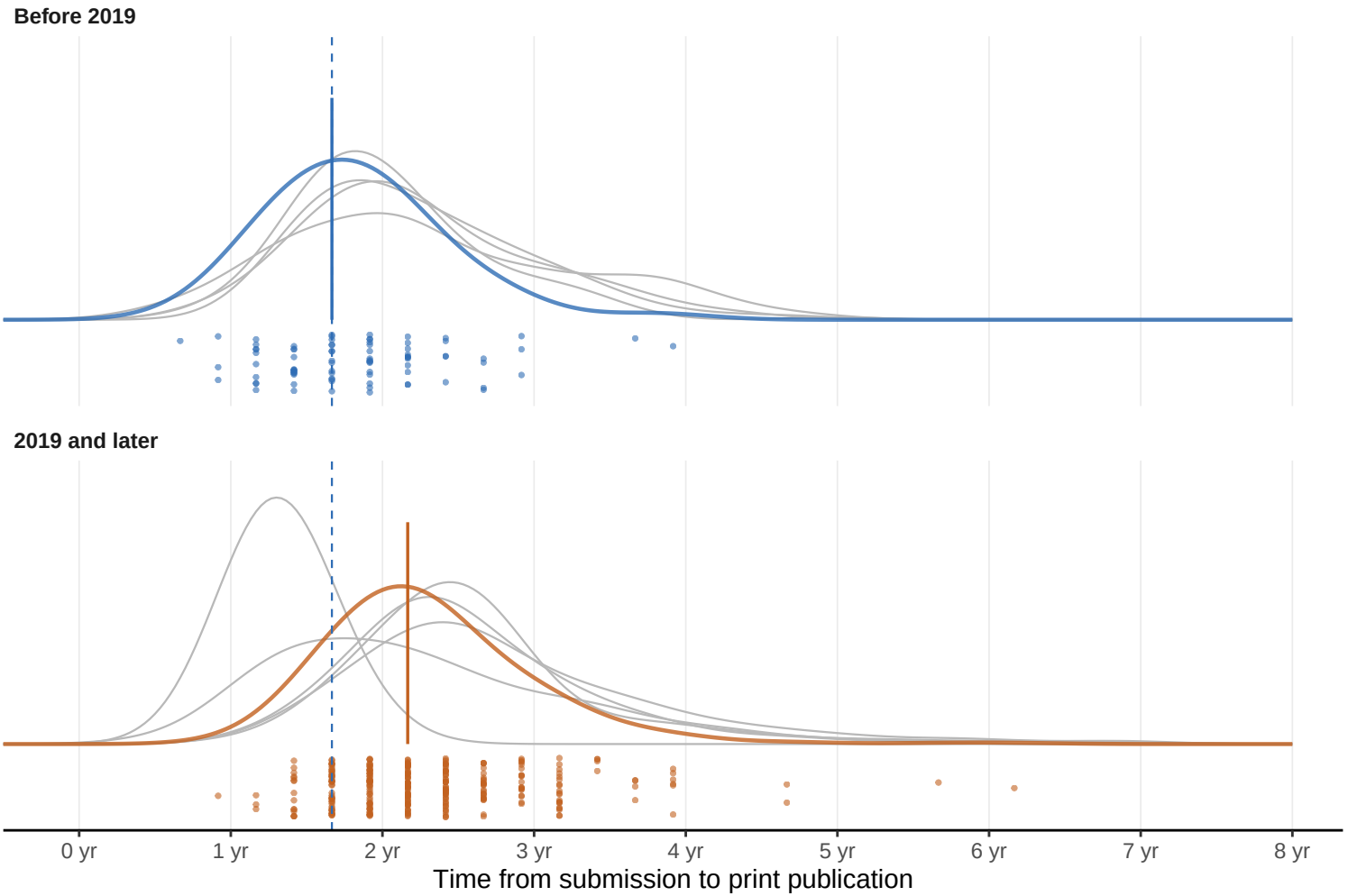
AEJ:Applied Economics: delay from submission to publication

Before: 2017−2018 (n = 85); after: 2019−2024 (n = 301); Median shift +6 months; mean +5.8 [4.0, 7.5]; Wilcoxon p < 0.001 (Holm)
Colored: AEJ:Applied Economics (points: articles; line: density; solid vertical: median; dashed: median before 2019). Grey: other AEA journals.



Submission: year and manuscript number from the DOI (e.g., 10.1257/aer.20151234). Within a submission year, the quartiles of the manuscript numbers of all published articles define the submission quarter (dated at its middle). Only submission years with at least 80% of their published articles observed with such a DOI are used, and only publication years with at least 90% of articles from those submission years. Publication: month of the print issue.
Delays fall on a grid of 3 months for the AEJs (quarterly issues), so the median shift is a multiple of 3 months.
Points: articles (jittered vertically). Lines: kernel density (bandwidth 4 months). Excluded: AEA P&P, JEL, JEP (no submission−based numbering).